

But First . . .

One quick word before we dive into these long-term goals. I want you to start working on these things as soon as possible, but not before you're ready. That means you need to be out of debt (except for the house) and have a fully funded emergency fund of three to six months' worth of expenses in the bank. If you haven't hit those two goals yet, that should be your focus right now. Trying to build wealth while dragging around a car note and student loan payments is like trying to run a marathon with an anchor tied around your ankle. All that debt will do is slow you down and split your efforts. Get your immediate financial situation in good shape first, and then move on to the long-term goals we're about to discuss. Got it?